



The bee uses its proboscis to suck up nectar to take back to the hive.

A good dusting

When a bee lands on a flower, its body is dusted with pollen. It collects this pollen in pollen baskets on its back legs, but enough is left to pollinate other flowers.



Pollen

Magnified many times, pollen grains are differently shaped depending on their parent plant. Some have spiky casings.

The bee mixes pollen with nectar, making it sticky so it stays in the pollen baskets.

Busy as a bee

Bees pollinate many of the world's crops, from apples and pears to cucumbers and melons. They zip between the flowers at the dizzy speed of 24 kph (15 mph).

